

THE GIFTS OF HEALINGS

BROWN DENOTES INSTRUCTIONS TO TECHNICIAN
BLUE DENOTES POWER POINT SLIDE

TEXT: 1 Corinthians 12:1-11 (KJV) *“Now concerning spiritual gifts, brethren, I would not have you ignorant. ²Ye know that ye were Gentiles, carried away unto these dumb idols, even as ye were led. ³Wherefore I give you to understand, that no man speaking by the Spirit of God calleth Jesus accursed: and that no man can say that Jesus is the Lord, but by the Holy Ghost. ⁴Now there are diversities of gifts, but the same Spirit. ⁵And there are differences of administrations, but the same Lord. ⁶And there are diversities of operations, but it is the same God which worketh all in all. ⁷But the manifestation of the Spirit is given to every man to profit withal. ⁸For to one is given by the Spirit the word of wisdom; to another the word of knowledge by the same Spirit; ⁹To another faith by the same Spirit; to another the gifts of healing by the same Spirit; ¹⁰To another the working of miracles; to another prophecy; to another discerning of spirits; to another divers kinds of tongues; to another the interpretation of tongues: ¹¹But all these worketh that one and the selfsame Spirit, dividing to every man severally as he will.”*

TEXT: During this study I want to attempt to address several **commonly asked questions regarding this wonderful gift:** **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Is healing for today?
- Is it God's will to heal everyone?
- Why do certain people receive their healing and others do not?
- Are the gifts of healing a one size fits all proposition?
- How do I allow this wonderful gift to operate in my life?

I. IS HEALING FOR TODAY?

Some people believe that the gifts ceased at the close of the apostolic age. Those who believe this normally use the following scripture to prove their point. 1 Corinthians 13:8-10 (NKJV) *"Love never fails. But whether there are prophecies, they will fail; whether there are tongues, they will cease; whether there is knowledge, it will vanish away."* *9 For we know in part and we prophesy in part. 10 But when that which is perfect has come, then that which is in part will be done away."* Those who use this scripture to support their view of the gifts, also believe what the scripture is referring to when it says *"when that which is perfect is come"*, is the Bible. I believe the Bible to be inerrant, but the Bible is certainly not what this scripture is speaking of. If this view were correct not only would gifts have ceased with the completion of Holy Scripture but knowledge would have been stymied as well. None of us could embrace a belief that says knowledge has not increased since the completion of the canon of scripture, yet many persist in believing gifts have ceased. If knowledge is increasing the use of gifts should be increasing as well.

Healing is a cardinal doctrine of the Word of God.

(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

Exodus 15:26 (KJV) *"If thou wilt diligently hearken to the voice of the LORD thy God, and wilt do that which is right in his sight, and wilt give ear to his commandments, and keep all his statutes, I will put none of these diseases upon thee, which I have brought upon the Egyptians: for I am the LORD that healeth thee."* This word "healeth" means the

continuation of healing. He does not heal once and say, "*that's all you get*" but He "*forgiveth all thine iniquities, and He healeth all thy diseases*". The word forgiveth and the word healeth are continuous action verbs which mean that as long as the need for forgiveness or healing exists the gift will continue to be an active, viable gift. **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)**

II. IS IT GODS WILL TO HEAL EVERYONE?

I am convinced the answer to this question is absolutely yes. From the fiery serpent in the wilderness through the apostolic age there is iron clad scriptural proof that God's intentions were and are to heal everyone. The following are a list of scriptures to consider: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Numbers 21:8 - Note the words "*Every one*".
- Matthew 12:15 - "*He healed them all.*"
- Luke 4:40 - "*He laid His hands on every one of them, and healed them.*"
- Luke 6:19 - "*He healed them all.*"
- Luke 9:6 - The Apostles "*Preached the Gospel and healed everywhere.*"

- Luke 9:11 - Jesus *"Healed them that had need of healing."*
- Acts 5:14-16 - Multitudes who were sick and vexed with devils came to the ministry of Peter and vs. 16 say's *"And they were healed every one."* (They brought the sick and lined the streets so that the shadow of Peter would fall upon them and they would be healed)

The very first covenant the Lord made with the children of Israel after they left the land of Egypt is the Covenant of Healing. Exodus 15:26 (NKJV) *"If you diligently heed the voice of the LORD your God and do what is right in His sight, give ear to His commandments and keep all His statutes, I will put none of the diseases on you which I have brought on the Egyptians. For I am the LORD who heals you."*

This covenant is a conditional covenant. There are four conditions set forth for their healing: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Hear and obey the voice of the Lord thy God
- Do that which is right in the sight of the Lord
- Listen to his commandments
- Keep all his laws

God told them that if they would behave themselves and keep their end of the bargain that He would keep His end of the covenant by taking care of their bodies. They struggled in fulfilling their part of the covenant but God kept His part of the agreement. David tells us in Psalm 105:37(KJV) *"He brought them forth also*

with silver and gold; and *there was not one feeble person among their tribes.*

In the Word of God, it is apparent that on multiple occasions all were healed. If this were true then certainly all can be healed now! Hebrews 13:8 (NKJV) ***"Jesus Christ is the same yesterday, today, and forever."***

III. WHY DO SOME PEOPLE GET HEALED AND OTHERS DO NOT?

The only scriptural reasons I can find for people not being healed are: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Sin
- A lack of faith
- Too much doubt
- Un-belief

Even Jesus could not do many miracles in Nazareth because of the abundance of unbelief.

It is God's will to save everyone, yet, everyone is not saved. The Scripture say's; ***"He is not willing that any should perish, but that all should come to repentance."***

All are not saved and healed because: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Some have never heard that Jesus saves. Many have not been taught that He heals.
- Some do not believe salvation is for them. Some do not believe healing is for them. Unbelief doesn't bring healing any more than it

brings salvation.

- Some fail to get saved because they refuse to meet the conditions set forth in the Word of God. Some do not get healed because they fail to meet the requirements of the Word of God.
- Some do not get saved because they cannot bring themselves to believe the finished work of Christ to be sufficient to forgive their sins. Some do not get healed because they cannot believe the work of Christ can become personal.

As born again believers, we should believe Christ is not only able to heal but is also willing to heal. He is at least as willing as He is able!

Healing is provided for in the atonement. Isaiah 53:5 (NKJV) ***"But He was wounded for our transgressions, He was bruised for our iniquities; The chastisement for our peace was upon Him, And by His stripes we are healed."***

IV. ARE THE GIFTS OF HEALING A ONE SIZE FITS ALL PROPOSITION?

Of course the answer to this question is no, absolutely not!

In 1 Corinthians chapter twelve this gift is mentioned three times; in verse nine; in verse twenty-eight; and in verse thirty. In the King James Version the first noun is plural and the second is singular but in the original manuscripts, all three times, both appear in the plural form. The plurality of both nouns in the sentence

seems to point up the possibility of many gifts of healings for many different diseases.

The use of every day examples to teach spiritual truth can be risky and somewhat inadequate but Jesus found it necessary to resort to such tactics in order to impart spiritual truth. So allow me to use the following example. In the medical field there are general practitioners and there are specialists. Your family doctor is more than likely a general practitioner and unless you have a serious or prolonged illness he will normally be able to walk you through most of your health issues. However, when your health problems go beyond normal and routine maladies your primary care physician will refer you to a specialist.

If you break your foot you do not go to see your good friend who is an oncologist, you go to see an orthopedic surgeon.

The Gifts of healings, as you can readily see, are in the double plural tense. It is the only one of the nine spiritual gifts grammatically constructed in this way. My experience in kingdom work lets me know that those who function in a gift of healing often feel more drawn to pray with persons with a particular disease than to pray for various other diseases. This is certainly not set in stone but is normally the case.

Here is the revelation of my understanding; **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- There are as many gifts of healing as there are diseases.
- Within every body of believers there should be a

gift of healing for every disease.

- There are no incurable diseases with the Lord.

No one is hopeless, nothing is too hard for the Lord, and all things are possible to those who believe.

God can certainly manifest any one of His gifts through anyone who will yield to it. Because we are human, we may have a greater level of faith to pray for one disease over another. In such a case it becomes even more important that all function in the area of their giftedness.

There are some who know they have a healing ministry; yet, become grieved and burdened when all manner of sicknesses and diseases do not yield to their prayers or commands. I think we could say with a definite degree of certainty that the gifts of healings are certainly not a one size fits all proposition.

One of the problems with the modern day church is that we have a tendency to generalize, painting everything with a really broad brush. We like our religion in a one size fits all package. We deal in generalities far too often, setting ourselves up for failure to seize and receive the miraculous. God desires to allow us to see the miraculous but He normally reserves the miraculous for those who deal with Him in specifics rather than generalities.

(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)

Following the miracle of the loaves and the fish Jesus sent His disciples away by ship, on the Sea of Galilee. During the course of their voyage an unexpected wind began to threaten the ship. Jesus sees them *"straining at rowing"* and walks on the sea in close proximity to the ship. Notice St. Mark's description of the event: Mark 6:48-49 (NKJV) *"Then He saw them straining at rowing, for the wind was against them. Now about the fourth watch of the night He came to them, walking on the sea, and would have passed them by."* *49 And when they saw Him walking on the sea, they supposed it was a ghost, and cried out;"*

According to this passage of Scripture they would have missed their miracle, but their cry activated the miraculous.

Look at the story of the Leper in Matthew chapter eight. Matthew 8:1-3 (NKJV) *"When He had come down from the mountain, great multitudes followed Him. 2 And behold, a leper came and worshiped Him, saying, 'Lord, if You are willing, You can make me clean.'"* *3 Then Jesus put out His hand and touched him, saying, 'I am willing; be cleansed.'"* *Immediately his leprosy was cleansed."* Again, the expectant cry of the sick activated the miraculous!

I think we could say with a definite degree of certainty that the gifts of healings are certainly not a one size fits all proposition.

V. HOW DO I ALLOW THIS WONDERFUL GIFT TO OPERATE IN MY LIFE?

In order to discover the proper usage of this gift we need only to look at the life and ministry of Jesus.

One of the interesting features of the ministry of Jesus is that the scripture repeatedly points up the fact that He was *"moved with compassion"* toward the plight of others. Nine times in the four gospels the word compassion is used to describe Jesus' dealings with individuals or multitudes. Oftentimes this resulted in people receiving their healing: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- [Matthew 14:14](#) (NKJV) *"And when Jesus went out He saw a great multitude; and He was moved with compassion for them, and healed their sick."*
- [Matthew 20:29-34](#) (NKJV) *"Now as they went out of Jericho, a great multitude followed Him.³⁰ And behold, two blind men sitting by the road, when they heard that Jesus was passing by, cried out, saying, 'Have mercy on us, O Lord, Son of David!'"³¹ Then the multitude warned them that they should be quiet; but they cried out all the more, saying, 'Have mercy on us, O Lord, Son of David!'"³² So Jesus stood still and called them, and said, 'What do you want Me to do for you?'"³³ They said to Him, 'Lord, that our eyes may be opened.'"³⁴ So Jesus had compassion and touched their eyes. And immediately their eyes received sight, and they followed Him."*
- [Mark 1:40-42](#) (NKJV) *"Now a leper came to Him, imploring Him, kneeling down to Him and saying to Him, 'If You are willing, You can make me clean.'"⁴¹ Then Jesus, moved with compassion, stretched out His hand and*

*touched him, and said to him, "I am willing; be cleansed."*⁴² *As soon as He had spoken, immediately the leprosy left him, and he was cleansed."*

Those who have received the gifts of healings must learn to recognize the prompting of the Holy Spirit and allow the timely operation of this gift in all situations.

Those who have received this gift: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Will know the gift is in operation in their life.
- Will know what area of illness they are drawn to pray for.
- Will recognize the prompting of the Holy Spirit when they are to pray for certain people for certain reasons. (In Jesus' ministry it was called compassion)
- Will have a genuine desire to be used in the gift.
- Will seek out opportunities to allow for the usage of the gift.

The modern day church is in dire need of the manifestation of this wonderful gift. It is time for local churches and pastors to train, equip, and empower the people to step out in faith especially in the operation of the gifts. Matthew 10:5-8 (NKJV) *"These twelve Jesus sent out and commanded them, saying: "Do not go into the way of the Gentiles, and do not enter a city of the Samaritans.⁶ "But go rather to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.⁷ "And as you go, preach, saying, 'The kingdom of heaven is at hand.'⁸*

“Heal the sick, cleanse the lepers, raise the dead, cast out demons. Freely you have received, freely give.”

PRACTICAL APPLICATION:

The following guidelines must be remembered and followed in the usage of this wonderful gift: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME THEN LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE END OF THE SERVICE)**

- Seek the gift; ask God to allow this gift to work in your life.
- Before laying hands on an individual ask for the gift to work through you.
- Be sensitive to the prompting of the Holy Spirit and obey no matter how ridiculous it may seem. (Know when to act and when to be silent)
- Pray in faith never allowing doubt to cloud your thoughts.
- Speak any words of faith God places in your heart.
- Don't close your eyes when you pray, you may miss something!